



Mónica Céspedes Berdonces

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EDUCATION

[09/2021 – Current]

Psychology Student at Complutense University of Madrid (UCM)

Final-year Psychology student specializing in behavioral **neuroscience**, focused on cognitive and neural mechanisms underlying mental health and behavior. Currently holding a **GPA of 8.77/10** and awarded **7 Honors distinctions** for academic excellence

[09/2024 – 06/2025]

Psychology Student at the University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)

Completed fourth year of Psychology studies at UCLA through the competitive *California Scholarship* program from the *Complutense University of Madrid*. Achieved a **4.0/4.0 GPA** and earned Honors in 7 out of 10 courses, demonstrating strong academic performance and advanced engagement with course material

[09/2019 – 06/2021]

Dual high-school diploma

Bilingual academic pathway in Spanish and French, obtaining the French *Baccalauréat*. Achieved a university entrance score of **13,708/14**, ranking among the top national admissions profiles

WORK EXPERIENCE

[09/2025 – Current]

Student Intern at UCEAP (University of California Education Abroad Program)

Intern at the University of California Education Abroad Program (UCEAP), supporting academic and cultural programming for UC students in Madrid. Involved in event coordination, student support, and cross-institutional collaboration with UCM and the University of California

[01/2026 – 25/03/2026]

Clinical Psychology Intern at Montreal Psychiatric Day Hospital

Clinical Psychology Intern completing my curricular placement while contributing to the TIPS Spanish research project (Childhood Trauma and Subclinical Psychosis). This experience allows me to integrate clinical practice and research in a real mental health setting with adolescent and young adult populations.

ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

[11/2025 – Current]

Research Assistant - Collaboration Grant

Research Assistant in the **TIPS project (Childhood Trauma and Subclinical Psychosis)**, examining the relationship between childhood maltreatment, post-traumatic symptoms, and subclinical psychotic experiences in adolescents and young adults.

[06/2025]

Specialized UCM Programs in Intelligence Research & Suicide Prevention (El Escorial)

Completed two advanced academic programs: one examining models of **human intelligence** through neuroscience and molecular genetics, and another analyzing **suicide** from biological, clinical, and sociocultural perspectives. Both programs were taught by international researchers and mental-health professionals

[11/2023 – 06/2024]

Research Assistant at UCM

Collaborative research role supporting UCM faculty and primary school pupils from Madrid in joint projects. Presenter and contributor to the study *"Differences in Emotional Intelligence and Well-being by Sex and Age"*, presented at the **XVI UCM Health Sciences Congress**

[09/2022 – 12/2022]

Teaching Assistant at UCM

Provided classroom support for psychology courses, offering academic assistance and guidance to undergraduate students

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

[09/2025 – Current]

Founder and President at "La Sección Prohibida" Association (UCM)

Founder and President of a recognized UCM student association **promoting literary and cultural engagement** on campus. Developed the association's vision, supervised activities and partnerships, and fostered an inclusive literary community

[07/2025]

Contributor at Baladí Literary & Cultural Magazine (UCM)

Published two original articles exploring psychology and reading culture, contributing to the dissemination of cognitive science concepts and literary engagement among the student community

[09/2021 – 06/2024]

Resident at Teresa de Jesús Residence Hall (UCM)

Founder of the *Leisure Committee*, leading the design and implementation of cultural and community events for residents. Promoted student engagement, fostered a sense of community, and actively contributed to residence life and institutional traditions

VOLUNTEERING

[07/2025]

Volunteer at Madrid Food Bank Participated in food collection and distribution, coordinating deliveries and providing resources and guidance to partner charities

LANGUAGES

IELTS Academic: Band 8 (C1)

DELF French: B2